

20 prompts for indie hackers and app founders

20
PROMPTS

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4 AI
COMPATIBLE

\$19
USD

Tech & Startups

Works with: **ChatGPT** • **Claude** • **Gemini** • **Llama**

About This Playbook

20 expert prompts for founders launching on Product Hunt, App Store, Google Play, and the broader indie hacker ecosystem.

What You'll Get

• 20 expert prompts • Professional frameworks • Placeholder system • Expert tips per prompt

Who It's For

• Entrepreneurs • Professionals • Teams • Freelancers

How to Use This Playbook

- 1 Copy the prompt — Select the full prompt text from the section that matches your goal.
- 2 Fill in the brackets — Replace all [PLACEHOLDER] text with your specific context, brand, or product.
- 3 Paste & generate — Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or your preferred AI tool.
- 4 Iterate — Use the output as a starting point. Refine with follow-up prompts for best results.

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Section 1

Section 1 (4 prompts)

Prompt #01

Product Hunt Launch Strategy

Plan the complete launch strategy for [PRODUCT] on Product Hunt.

You are a Product Hunt launch expert. Plan the complete launch strategy for [PRODUCT] on Product Hunt. Deliver: 1. Pre-launch (30 days): Hunter selection, community building, badge creation 2. Launch day: Timing (12:01am PST), update cadence, maker comment strategy 3. How to get votes legitimately 4. Assets needed (video, screenshots, tagline) 5. Post-launch: Follow up with commenters

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Top Product Hunt launches are planned 30 days out. Launching without preparation rarely hits #1.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #02

App Store Listing Optimization

Optimize [APP NAME] for App Store and Google Play search.

You are an ASO specialist. Optimize [APP NAME] for App Store and Google Play search. Deliver: Title + subtitle 5 keywords (App Store) Description structure Screenshot copy Preview video script A/B testing strategy

Placeholders: [APP NAME] Your app

■ **Tip:** App Store screenshots convert more than any other listing element. Design them like ads.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #03

Indie Hacker Launch Checklist

Create a complete launch checklist for [PRODUCT] across all indie plat

You are an indie hacker community expert. Create a complete launch checklist for [PRODUCT] across all indie platforms. Deliver: Day -7 through Day +7: Product Hunt, Hacker News Show HN, Reddit, Indie Hackers, Twitter/X, LinkedIn For each platform: What to post + timing + expectations

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Show HN posts with a genuine founder story get more traction than feature-focused ones.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #04

Beta User Recruitment

Write outreach templates to recruit [X] beta users for [PRODUCT].

You are a sales leader with 15+ years in B2B and B2C sales. Write outreach templates to recruit [X] beta users for [PRODUCT]. Deliver: Message types: Existing network, Reddit communities, Twitter, LinkedIn, Product Hunt upcoming page For each: Message template + platform norms + expected response rate

Placeholders: [X] Number of beta users [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** The easiest beta users to recruit are people who've publicly complained about the problem you solve.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Section 2

Section 2 (4 prompts)

Prompt #05

Launch Email to Waitlist

Write the launch day email for [PRODUCT] to [WAITLIST SIZE] subscriber

You are an email launch specialist. Write the launch day email for [PRODUCT] to [WAITLIST SIZE] subscribers. Deliver: Subject (3 options) Opening (the moment + the announcement) What it is + key features Early access offer How to get started P.S. (Product Hunt vote ask)

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product [WAITLIST SIZE] Subscriber count

■ **Tip:** Launch day emails should go out at 8am local time for your largest audience segment.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #06

Maker Comment Strategy for Product Hunt

Write the maker comment strategy for [PRODUCT]'s Product Hunt launch.

You are a community engagement specialist. Write the maker comment strategy for [PRODUCT]'s Product Hunt launch. Deliver: Initial post (under your listing): Founder story + invitation to ask questions 3 comment response frameworks: Question / Feedback / Skeptical Comment tone guide + what to avoid

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Maker comments that tell an honest story (including challenges) get more upvotes than polished marketing.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #07

ASO Keyword Research

Research the best keywords for [APP TYPE] in the App Store.

You are an App Store optimization specialist. Research the best keywords for [APP TYPE] in the App Store. Deliver: Keyword research methodology Top 30 keywords with difficulty and relevance Long-tail opportunities Competitor keyword analysis Seasonal keyword strategy

Placeholders: [APP TYPE] Your app category

■ **Tip:** App Store keyword competition is less intense than Google. Niche keywords often outperform broad ones.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #08

Product Video Script

Write the product launch video script for [PRODUCT] (60-90 seconds).

You are a product demo specialist. Write the product launch video script for [PRODUCT] (60-90 seconds). Deliver: [0-5s]: Hook (the problem in one moment) [5-20s]: How it's solved [20-60s]: Key features in action [60-90s]: Result + CTA + Thumbnail concept

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Product launch videos that show the product working (not just talking about it) convert 3x better.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Section 3

Section 3 (4 prompts)

Prompt #09

Pricing Page Optimization

Write a high-converting pricing page for [PRODUCT/APP].

You are a pricing conversion specialist. Write a high-converting pricing page for [PRODUCT/APP]. Deliver: Tier names (persona-based) Feature lists (benefits-first) FAQ (9 questions) Free trial or freemium framing + Annual discount presentation

Placeholders: [PRODUCT/APP] Your product

■ **Tip:** Indie products price too low 90% of the time. Test price increases before assuming you're priced right.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #10

App Store Review Strategy

Build an in-app review request strategy for [APP].

You are a reputation management specialist. Build an in-app review request strategy for [APP]. Deliver: 1. When to ask (after first 'aha moment') 2. How to ask (in-app prompt copy) 3. Rating threshold for hard ask vs soft ask 4. Response templates for 1-3 star reviews 5. Review response strategy

Placeholders: [APP] Your app

■ **Tip:** In-app review prompts after a user achieves their goal convert at 25-40%.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #11

Hacker News Show HN Post

Write a Show HN post for [PRODUCT].

You are a HN community member. Write a Show HN post for [PRODUCT]. Deliver: Title formula: 'Show HN: [Product Name] - [One-line description with specific benefit]' Body (200-300 words): - The problem you built it for - Your approach - Current state (alpha/beta/launched) - Specific feedback you want

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Show HN posts that ask for specific feedback (not just upvotes) get more engagement.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #12

Twitter/X Build in Public Strategy

Create a build in public strategy on Twitter for [FOUNDER] launching [

You are a build in public expert. Create a build in public strategy on Twitter for [FOUNDER] launching [PRODUCT]. Deliver: What to share: Milestones, failures, learnings, behind the scenes What not to share: Competitive advantage, unpublished customer data Frequency: 3-5 tweets/week Milestone tweet templates

Placeholders: [FOUNDER] Founder [PRODUCT] Product

■ **Tip:** Build in public creates an audience before launch. The best launches happen to audiences, not cold markets.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Section 4

Section 4 (4 prompts)

Prompt #13

Cold Outreach to First 10 Customers

Write outreach scripts for [FOUNDER] to get the first 10 paying custom

You are a startup sales specialist. Write outreach scripts for [FOUNDER] to get the first 10 paying customers for [PRODUCT]. Deliver: Where to find them: - Reddit communities - LinkedIn - Twitter search For each channel: Message template + what works

Placeholders: [FOUNDER] Founder [PRODUCT] Product

■ **Tip:** Your first 10 customers should come from your network. Every founder has at least 10 people they can call.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #14

App Onboarding Flow Copy

Write the onboarding flow copy for [APP].

You are a UX writer. Write the onboarding flow copy for [APP]. Deliver: Splash screen → Signup → First value moment For each screen: Headline + subheadline + button copy Empty state copy (before first use) Onboarding tooltip text

Placeholders: [APP] Your app

■ **Tip:** The onboarding flow is your #1 conversion optimization opportunity. Every word counts.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #15

Launch Day Social Blitz

Plan the launch day social media blitz for [PRODUCT].

You are a social media launch strategist. Plan the launch day social media blitz for [PRODUCT]. Deliver: Hour-by-hour schedule (launch day): - 12:01am: Product Hunt live - 7am: Twitter thread - 8am: LinkedIn post - 9am: Email list - 11am: Hacker News - 2pm: Update + results post For each: Exact post copy

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Launch day social coordination creates the perception of momentum. Plan every post in advance.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #16

Post-Launch Growth Plan

Create a 30-day post-launch growth plan for [PRODUCT].

You are a growth specialist. Create a 30-day post-launch growth plan for [PRODUCT]. Deliver: Week 1: Leverage launch momentum (follow up + press) Week 2: First customer success story Week 3: Content to explain the product Week 4: First A/B test + optimization For each week: Specific tactics + targets

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** The week after launch determines if you build a business or a failed launch story.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Section 5

Section 5 (4 prompts)

Prompt #17

Early Adopter Community Building

Build an early adopter community for [PRODUCT].

You are a community builder. Build an early adopter community for [PRODUCT]. Deliver: Platform: Slack/Discord/Telegram (which and why) First week content Engagement rituals How to turn users into advocates Feedback collection system

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Early adopter communities give you feedback, testimonials, and your first case studies.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #18

Freemium Conversion Strategy

Design a freemium-to-paid conversion strategy for [APP].

You are a SaaS conversion specialist. Design a freemium-to-paid conversion strategy for [APP]. Deliver: 1. Free vs paid feature split 2. In-app upgrade prompts (triggered by usage) 3. Email sequence to free users 4. Conversion rate benchmarks 5. What to do when conversion rate is low

Placeholders: [APP] Your app

■ **Tip:** Freemium apps with 2-5% paid conversion rates are considered healthy. Most start much lower.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #19

API and Developer Marketing

Market [PRODUCT] to developers through technical channels.

You are a developer relations specialist. Market [PRODUCT] to developers through technical channels. Deliver: 1. Documentation as marketing 2. GitHub presence strategy 3. Dev Twitter/X 4. Hacker News strategy 5. Developer newsletter placements 6. Open source strategy

Placeholders: [PRODUCT] Your product

■ **Tip:** Developer marketing is about credibility first. Developers trust what they can inspect.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #20

Cold Traffic Acquisition for Apps

Plan the first \$1,000 in paid acquisition for [APP].

You are a paid acquisition specialist. Plan the first \$1,000 in paid acquisition for [APP]. Deliver: Budget allocation by channel: App Store ads / Google UAC / Facebook/Meta / Reddit ads For each: Setup guide + targeting + creative approach + what to measure + Organic vs paid benchmark

Placeholders: [APP] Your app

■ **Tip:** Spend the first \$1K on learning: which channel has the best ROAS for your product category.

ChatGPT ✓

Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

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